

Real chart practice · Mr Luke (John Luke, DOB 16/12/1942, NHI DGY 2963)

How to chart on this chart

- 1. **Date and 24-hour time:** at the top of the column. Past midnight? New date. Janine’s VS deck · slide 33
- 2. **Respiratory rate and SpO₂:** write the number in the box for its band. Janine’s VS deck · slide 34: printed on the chart
- 3. **Oxygen:** tick Room air, or write the L/min on the Supplement row (that row scores 2 by itself).
Janine’s VS deck · slide 34: printed on the chart
- 4. **Temperature and heart rate:** an X at the exact value inside the row. Off the scale? Write the number instead.
Janine’s VS deck · slide 34: printed on the chart
- 5. **Blood pressure:** an ↑ arrowhead with its tip ON the systolic, a ↓ arrowhead with its tip ON the diastolic, a dotted line between. Only the systolic scores. VS demo video · 17:03 + slide 39
- 6. **Round numbers:** sit ON a line: 110 is the line between the 110s and the 100s rows. VS demo video · 17:03
- 7. **Level of consciousness:** tick the row. Janine’s VS deck · slide 34: printed on the chart
- 8. **EWS:** each value scores its zone colour: white 0, yellow 1, orange 2, pink 3, blue = call 777. Add them up, write the total, then follow the pathway. Janine’s VS deck · slide 34
- 9. **Pen:** blue or black. A mistake gets ONE line through it, so it can still be read. Janine’s VS deck · slide 33

Story A · Day 2, 18/08/22 → the left half

Mr Luke had his metoprolol CR and enalapril at 0800. Over the day his blood pressure and pulse drift down.

Time	RR	O ₂	SpO ₂	Temp	BP	HR	LOC
18/08							
0730	16	RA	97	36.8	132/78	72	A
1000	12	RA	98	36.9	110/60	64	A
1200	18	RA	96	37.0	120/70	58	A
1400	20	RA	95	36.7	104/58	52	A
1500	21	RA	94	36.6	96/54	48	A
1530	22	RA	95	36.5	86/50	44	A

Story B · Day 3 into day 4, 19/08 → 20/08/22 → the right half

A chest infection brewing overnight.

Time	RR	O ₂	SpO ₂	Temp	BP	HR	LOC
19/08							
1800	18	RA	96	37.6	138/82	84	A
2200	22	RA	94	38.2	142/84	96	A
20/08							
0200	24	2 L	93	38.9	128/74	108	A
0230	28	4 L	91	40.1	98/56	146	V

RA = room air · 2 L = 2 L/min oxygen · A = alert · V = responds to voice

Vital Signs		Date													EWS													Date
		Time (24 hour)																										Time (24 hour)
Respiratory Rate RR (breaths/min)		> 35													???													> 35
		25-35													3													25-35
		21-24													2													21-24
		12-20													0													12-20
		9-11													1													9-11
		write value in box																										
Oxygen	Room air ✓														0													✓ Room air
	Supplement (L/min)														2													Supplement (L/min)
Oxygen Saturation (%)		≥ 96													0													≥ 96
		94-95													1													94-95
		92-93													2													92-93
		write value in box																										
Temperature [°C]		≤ 91													3													≤ 91
		≥ 39s													2													≥ 39s
		38s													1													38s
		37s													0													37s
		36s																										36s
		mark with X write value if off scale																										
Blood Pressure BP (mmHg)		Write if ≥ 220													3													Write if ≥ 220
		210s																										210s
		200s																										200s
		190s																										190s
		180s																										180s
		170s																										170s
		160s													0													160s
		150s																										150s
		140s																										140s
		130s																										130s
		120s																										120s
		110s																										110s
		100s													1													100s
		90s													2													90s
		80s													3													80s
		70s																										70s
Heart Rate HR (bpm)		60s													0													60s
		50s													???													50s
		Write if ≥ 140													???													Write if ≥ 140
		130s													3													130s
		120s																										120s
		110s													2													110s
		100s													1													100s
		90s																										90s
		80s																										80s
		70s													0													70s
Level of Consciousness LOC (✓)		60s																										60s
		50s													2													50s
		40s													???													40s
		30s																										30s
		Alert													0													Alert
		Value													3													Value
Pain		Pain													3													Pain
		Unresponsive													???													Unresponsive
		Unresponsive																										
EARLY WARNING SCORE TOTAL																												EWS TOTAL
Pain	write score (0-10)	Rest																										Rest
		Movement																										Movement
Urine output (✓)	Catheter	≥ 300ml/4h																										≥ 300ml/4h
		< 300ml/4h																										< 300ml/4h
	No catheter	PU last 8h																										PU last 8h
		Not PU last 8h																										Not PU last 8h

Answers · turn this over until you've charted

Vital Signs		Date	18/08	18/08	18/08	18/08	18/08	18/08	18/08	19/08	19/08	20/08	20/08	Date
		Time (24 hour)	0730	1000	1200	1400	1500	1530		1800	2200	0200	0230	Time (24 hour)
Respiratory Rate RR (breaths/min)	> 35													> 35
	25-35											28		25-35
	21-24					21	22			22	24			21-24
	12-20	16	12	18	20					18				12-20
	9-11													9-11
write value in box														
Oxygen	Room air ✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓			✓	✓			✓ Room air
	Supplement (L/min)										2	4		Supplement (L/min)
Oxygen Saturation (%)	≥ 96	97	98	96						96				≥ 96
	94-95				95	94	95			94				94-95
	92-93										93			92-93
	≤ 91											91		≤ 91
Temperature [°C]	≥ 39s											40.1		≥ 39s
	38s													38s
	37s	×	×	×	×	×	×		×	×				37s
	36s													36s
	≤ 34s													≤ 34s
write value if off scale														
Blood Pressure BP (mmHg)	Write if ≥ 220													Write if ≥ 220
	210s													210s
	200s													200s
	190s													190s
	180s													180s
	170s													170s
	160s													160s
	150s													150s
	140s													140s
	130s													130s
	120s													120s
	110s													110s
	100s													100s
	90s													90s
	80s													80s
Heart Rate HR (bpm)	Write if ≥ 140											146		Write if ≥ 140
	130s													130s
	120s													120s
	110s													110s
	100s													100s
	90s													90s
	80s													80s
	70s	×							×					70s
	60s		×											60s
	50s			×										50s
40s				×		×	×						40s	
30s													30s	
mark with X write value if off scale														
Level of Consciousness LOC (✓)	Alert	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓			✓	✓	✓		Alert
	Verbal													Verbal
	Pain											✓		Pain
Unresponsive														Unresponsive
EARLY WARNING SCORE TOTAL			0	0	0	2	7	8		0	5	8	18	EWS TOTAL
Pain	write score (0-10)	Rest												Rest
		Movement												Movement
Urine output (✓)	Catheter	≥ 300ml/4h												≥ 300ml/4h
		< 300ml/4h											< 300ml/4h	
	No catheter	PU last 8h												PU last 8h
		Not PU last 8h												

Blue = what your pen should have written. Compare column by column: same row, same spot in the row, same arrows.

Story A · Day 2, 18/08/22

18/08 · 0730

EWS 0

RR 16	in the 12–20 box	white 0
O ₂ room air	tick Room air	white 0
SpO ₂ 97	in the ≥ 96 box	white 0
Temp 36.8	in the 36s row	white 0
BP 132/78	↑ in the 130s row · ↓ in the 70s row	white 0 (systolic)
HR 72	in the 70s row	white 0
LOC	tick Alert	white 0

EWS 0: Carry on with the ordered observation frequency.

A normal set still gets every value charted.

18/08 · 1000

EWS 0

RR 12	in the 12–20 box	white 0
O ₂ room air	tick Room air	white 0
SpO ₂ 98	in the ≥ 96 box	white 0
Temp 36.9	in the 36s row	white 0
BP 110/60	↑ ON the line under the 110s · ↓ ON the line under the 60s	white 0 (systolic)
HR 64	in the 60s row	white 0
LOC	tick Alert	white 0

EWS 0: Carry on with the ordered observation frequency.

The demo video's own numbers. 110 and 60 are round, so the tips go ON the lines: the ↑ on the line under the 110s, the ↓ on the line under the 60s (Janine at 17:03). RR 12 is still in the 12–20 box.

18/08 · 1200

EWS 0

RR 18	in the 12–20 box	white 0
O ₂ room air	tick Room air	white 0
SpO ₂ 96	in the ≥ 96 box	white 0
Temp 37.0	ON the line under the 37s	white 0
BP 120/70	↑ ON the line under the 120s · ↓ ON the line under the 70s	white 0 (systolic)
HR 58	in the 50s row	white 0
LOC	tick Alert	white 0

EWS 0: Carry on with the ordered observation frequency.

37.0 sits ON the line between the 37s and the 36s. HR 58 is in the 50s row, still white.

18/08 · 1400

EWS 2

RR 20	in the 12–20 box	white 0
O ₂ room air	tick Room air	white 0
SpO ₂ 95	in the 94–95 box	yellow 1
Temp 36.7	in the 36s row	white 0
BP 104/58	↑ in the 100s row · ↓ in the 50s row	yellow 1 (systolic)
HR 52	in the 50s row	white 0
LOC	tick Alert	white 0

EWS 1–5: Manage pain, fever or distress; consider increasing obs frequency in discussion with the senior nurse; document the outcome.

Two yellows (SpO₂ 95, systolic 104). EWS 2: tell your RN; more frequent obs is the senior nurse's call.

18/08 · 1500**EWS 7**

RR 21	in the 21–24 box	orange 2
O₂ room air	tick Room air	white 0
SpO₂ 94	in the 94–95 box	yellow 1
Temp 36.6	in the 36s row	white 0
BP 96/54	↑ in the 90s row · ↓ in the 50s row	orange 2 (systolic)
HR 48	in the 40s row	orange 2
LOC	tick Alert	white 0

EWS 6–7: Inform the nurse in charge; house officer review within 60 minutes; obs at least hourly.

RR 21 is the first number in the orange 21–24 box. HR 48 drops into the orange 40s row. EWS 7: tell the nurse in charge; house officer within 60 minutes.

18/08 · 1530**EWS 8**

RR 22	in the 21–24 box	orange 2
O₂ room air	tick Room air	white 0
SpO₂ 95	in the 94–95 box	yellow 1
Temp 36.5	in the 36s row	white 0
BP 86/50	↑ in the 80s row · ↓ ON the line under the 50s	pink 3 (systolic)
HR 44	in the 40s row	orange 2
LOC	tick Alert	white 0

EWS 8–9, or any vital sign in the red (pink) zone: Inform the nurse in charge; registrar review within 30 minutes; obs at least every 30 minutes.

Systolic 86 is in the pink 80s row. ANY value in the pink zone means a registrar review within 30 minutes, before you even add up. Diastolic 50 sits ON the bottom line of the BP rows.

Story B · Day 3 into day 4, 19/08 → 20/08/22**19/08 · 1800****EWS 0**

RR 18	in the 12–20 box	white 0
O₂ room air	tick Room air	white 0
SpO₂ 96	in the ≥ 96 box	white 0
Temp 37.6	in the 37s row	white 0
BP 138/82	↑ in the 130s row · ↓ in the 80s row	white 0 (systolic)
HR 84	in the 80s row	white 0
LOC	tick Alert	white 0

EWS 0: Carry on with the ordered observation frequency.
37.6: the X goes six-tenths of the way up the 37s row.

19/08 · 2200**EWS 5**

RR 22	in the 21–24 box	orange 2
O₂ room air	tick Room air	white 0
SpO₂ 94	in the 94–95 box	yellow 1
Temp 38.2	in the 38s row	yellow 1
BP 142/84	↑ in the 140s row · ↓ in the 80s row	white 0 (systolic)
HR 96	in the 90s row	yellow 1
LOC	tick Alert	white 0

EWS 1–5: Manage pain, fever or distress; consider increasing obs frequency in discussion with the senior nurse; document the outcome.

Four values moved. EWS 5 is still yellow: treat the fever, talk to the senior nurse about more frequent obs, write it down.

20/08 · 0200

EWS 8

RR 24	in the 21–24 box	orange 2
O₂ 2 L/min	write 2 on the Supplement row	orange 2
SpO₂ 93	in the 92–93 box	orange 2
Temp 38.9	in the 38s row	yellow 1
BP 128/74	↑ in the 120s row · ↓ in the 70s row	white 0 (systolic)
HR 108	in the 100s row	yellow 1
LOC	tick Alert	white 0

EWS 8–9, or any vital sign in the red (pink) zone: Inform the nurse in charge; registrar review within 30 minutes; obs at least every 30 minutes.

NEW DATE: it's past midnight, so this column is 20/08. He's on oxygen now: write 2 on the Supplement row. That row scores 2 by itself.

20/08 · 0230

EWS 18

RR 28	in the 25–35 box	pink 3
O₂ 4 L/min	write 4 on the Supplement row	orange 2
SpO₂ 91	in the ≤ 91 box	pink 3
Temp 40.1	WRITE 40.1 in the “≥ 39s” row	orange 2
BP 98/56	↑ in the 90s row · ↓ in the 50s row	orange 2 (systolic)
HR 146	WRITE 146 in the “Write if ≥ 140” row	BLUE: 777
LOC	tick Voice	pink 3

EWS 10+, or any vital sign in the blue zone: Dial 777, say “Code Red” and the location, stay with the patient, support airway, breathing and circulation.

Two values are OFF the scale, so you WRITE them: 40.1 in the ≥39s row, 146 in the “Write if ≥140” row. HR 146 is blue: dial 777 whatever the total. Responds to voice only = pink.

The escalation pathway printed on the chart



MUST ATTACH PATIENT LABEL HERE

SURNAME: _____ NOB: _____
FIRST NAMES: _____ DOB: _____

Please ensure you attach the correct visit patient label

CALL 777 FOR ANY PATIENT YOU, THEY OR THEIR FAMILY ARE WORRIED ABOUT, REGARDLESS OF VITAL SIGNS OR EARLY WARNING SCORE (EWS)

Mandatory escalation pathway	
Total EWS Warning Score	Action
EWS 1-5	- Manage pain, fever or distress - Consider increasing observation frequency in discussion with senior nurse - Document outcome of discussion
EWS 6-7 Acute illness or unstable chronic disease	House officer review within 60 minutes (call team/on call registrar if H/O unavailable) - Inform nurse in charge - Increase observations to minimum q60 minutes - CNS/PaR nurse review within 60 minutes
EWS 8-9 or any vital sign in red zone Likely to deteriorate rapidly	Registrar review within 30 minutes (call team/on call SMO if registrar unavailable) - Inform nurse in charge - Increase observations to minimum q30 minutes - CNS/PaR nurse review within 30 minutes
EWS 10+ or any vital sign in blue zone Immediately life threatening critical illness	- Dial 777 - State 'Code Red' and give the patient's location - Stay with the patient - Support airway, breathing and circulation

Modification to Early Warning Score (EWS) Triggers

The EWS can be changed to prevent chronic disease incorrectly triggering escalation. All modifications should be made in line with local policy and regularly reviewed by the primary team.

Ignore any modification that is not signed and dated.

Vital sign (see abbreviation)	Accepted values and modified EWS	Date and time	Duration (hours or days)	Name and contact details
		/ /		
Reason:				
		/ /		
Reason:				
		/ /		
Reason:				
NOT FOR CPR	☐	NOT FOR CODE RED	☐	/ /

All treatment limitations must be documented in the patient's clinical record.

A full set of vital signs with corresponding EWS must be taken and calculated each time at the frequency stated in policy. If there is no timely response to your request for review, escalate to the next coloured zone.